CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

VIDEOGRAPHER IN THE AI ERA

Every business suddenly needs video every week — and most owners would rather do anything than film and edit it themselves.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K median for shooters who can get competent in 1–6 months and sell to businesses, weddings and creators. The catch: you are selling a service business, not just pressing record. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

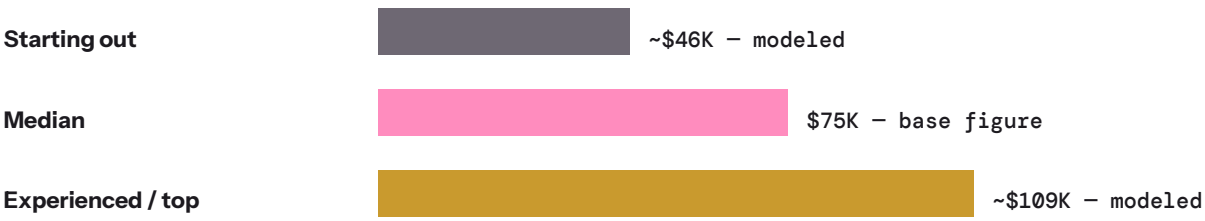
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: video is now the default language of selling, and demand sits with small businesses that cannot hire in-house.
- Where it bites: editing time dwarfs shooting time until your workflow matures.
- The AI angle: AI cuts, captions and reframes automatically — clients still pay for someone who shows up and makes the day easy.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Videographer is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A VIDEOGRAPHER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Plan, shoot and light interviews, events, products and properties
- ✓ Edit long and short cuts with captions, music and graphics
- ✓ Run shoots for clients who hate being on camera
- ✓ Deliver on content calendars, not one-off favors

Think: a one-person TV crew with a marketing department attached.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Auto-editing, captions, noise removal and reframing for every platform come standard in the tools now. Rough cuts that took a day take an hour.	Direction stays human: getting a nervous owner to sound like themselves, finding the story in a boring business, and being reliable on shoot day. Clients rebook the experience, not the render.

⚠ **Gear is not the moat — reliability is. The videographer who delivers on time with zero drama beats the artist who vanishes into an edit for three weeks.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Varied subjects: products, people, places, events ✓ Strong demand from local businesses and creators ✓ Retainer work can smooth the income	✗ Editing caves: long solo screen hours ✗ Clients who think video is a one-button job ✗ Weekend events compete with your own life

Good fit? You like cameras and people equally, and you finish things on deadline without being chased.
Bad fit? You want pure art with no client notes, revisions or calendars.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — SHOOT FOR CREATORS & BUSINESSES	DOOR B — PRODUCTION COMPANY FREELANCE
Offer simple, productized shoots to local businesses and creators: a half-day, a set number of finished clips, fixed price. Volume builds skill, portfolio and recurring clients faster than waiting for big productions.	Crew for production companies and busy lead videographers: second camera, audio, lighting. You learn professional set craft and get referrals when they overflow.

Smart move: Sell monthly retainers, not single videos. Four businesses paying monthly for content beats forty one-off gigs you have to re-sell every month.
Where you land after: A content studio with retainer clients, a wedding film brand, or a small crew under your direction.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
SHOOT AND	AUDIO AND	PRODUCTIZE AN	FIRST FIVE	SYSTEMIZE EDITING	CONVERT TO

STEP 1 — Shoot and cut daily reps

FREE · WEEKS 1-3

- One short video a day: interview, product, place
- Learn your editor until the keys are reflexes

STEP 2 — Audio and light before lenses

$200-500 · MONTH 1

- A decent mic and one good light change everything
- Bad audio kills more paid video than bad cameras

STEP 3 — Productize an offer

MONTH 1-2

- One clear package for one buyer type
- Fixed deliverables, fixed turnaround, deposit up front

STEP 4 — First five clients

MONTHS 2-3

- Businesses you already know; creators who post often
- Over-deliver slightly, then ask for the monthly version

STEP 5 — Systemize editing

MONTHS 3-5

- Templates for captions, intros and exports per client
- Batch editing days instead of daily drips

STEP 6 — Convert to retainers

MONTHS 5-6

- Monthly content packages for your best clients
- Raise one-off prices to make retainers the obvious deal

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

 Today: film and edit one 60-second video of anything, start to finish.

- Days 1–30: daily reps; build your mic-and-light kit; draft one clear package.
- Days 31–60: pitch local businesses and creators; shoot your first paid jobs.
- Days 61–90: convert happy clients to monthly content; tighten editing templates.
- Day 90: a working videographer with recurring clients in sight — that is the business.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ SHOW UP. SHOOT CLEAN. DELIVER ON TIME. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.